

Reporting Verbs for Assertive Sentences

Assertive sentence (कथनात्मक वाक्य) is a sentence that states a fact, opinion, thought, information, belief, or feeling. In indirect speech, **said/told** are not always the best choices; the reporting verb can be changed according to the meaning of the statement.

1. General Statement / सामान्य कथन

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning	Example
said	भन्यो/भनिन्	He said that he was tired.
stated	बताए/उल्लेख गरे	He stated that he was innocent.
declared	घोषणा गरे	He declared that he was ready.

announced	घोषणा गरे	The principal announced that the school would remain closed.
remarked	टिप्पणी गरे	He remarked that the movie was interesting.
observed	टिप्पणी/अवलोकन गरे	She observed that the road was unsafe.
mentioned	उल्लेख गरे	He mentioned that he had met Ram.
added	थपे	He added that he would help us.

2. Giving Information / सूचना वा जानकारी दिँदा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
informed	जानकारी दिए
notified	सूचना दिए
reported	रिपोर्ट/जानकारी दिए

explained	व्याख्या गरे
described	वर्णन गरे
related	घटना/कुरा सुनाए
communicated	जानकारी/सन्देश दिए
revealed	खुलासा गरे
disclosed	गोप्य कुरा खुलाए

Example:

Direct: He said, “The meeting will begin at ten.”

Indirect: He **informed us that** the meeting would begin at ten.

Nepali: उसले बैठक दस बजे सुरु हुने जानकारी दियो।

3. Giving an Opinion / विचार वा राय व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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opined	राय व्यक्त गरे
remarked	टिप्पणी गरे
commented	टिप्पणी गरे
observed	विचार/टिप्पणी व्यक्त गरे
expressed the view	विचार व्यक्त गरे
argued	तर्क गरे
maintained	आफ्नो धारणा कायम राखे
contended	दृढतापूर्वक तर्क गरे

Example:

Direct: He said, “I think this plan is better.”

Indirect: He **opined that** that plan was better.

Nepali: उसले त्यो योजना राम्रो भएको राय व्यक्त गर्‍यो।

4. Expressing Belief / विश्वास व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
believed	विश्वास गरे
thought	सोचे
considered	ठाने/माने
supposed	अनुमान/विश्वास गरे
assumed	अनुमान गरे
felt	महसुस/ठाने
trusted	विश्वास गरे

Example:

Direct: She said, “I believe that he is honest.”

Indirect: She **believed that** he was honest.

5. Expressing Knowledge / ज्ञान वा जानकारी भएको कुरा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
knew	थाहा थियो
realized	महसुस/बुझे
understood	बुझे
recognized	पहिचान गरे/बुझे
remembered	समझे
recalled	स्मरण गरे

Example:

Direct: He said, "I know the truth."

Indirect: He **said that he knew** the truth.

Note: Some verbs such as *knew*, *realized*, and *understood* are used according to the actual meaning of the sentence, not mechanically as replacements for *said*.

6. Expressing Certainty / निश्चितता व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
affirmed	दृढतापूर्वक पुष्टि गरे
confirmed	पुष्टि गरे
assured	आश्वस्त पारे
asserted	दृढतापूर्वक दाबी गरे
insisted	जोड दिए
emphasized	जोड दिए
guaranteed	ग्यारेन्टी/निश्चितता दिए

Example:

Direct: He said, "I am telling the truth."

Indirect: He **affirmed that** he was telling the truth.

7. Expressing Agreement / सहमति जनाउँदा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
agreed	सहमत भए
accepted	स्वीकार गरे
admitted	स्वीकार गरे
conceded	अनिच्छापूर्वक स्वीकार गरे
acknowledged	स्वीकार/मान्यता दिए
concurred	सहमत भए

Example:

Direct: Ram said, “You are right.”

Indirect: Ram **agreed that** I was right.

8. Expressing Disagreement / असहमति जनाउँदा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
disagreed	असहमत भए
denied	अस्वीकार गरे
contradicted	खण्डन गरे
objected	आपत्ति जनाए
refuted	गलत साबित गर्दै खण्डन गरे
disputed	विवाद/असहमति जनाए

Example:

Direct: He said, "I did not steal the money."

Indirect: He **denied that** he had stolen the money.

9. Expressing Admission / गल्ती वा तथ्य स्वीकार गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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admitted	स्वीकार गरे
confessed	स्वीकार गरे/कबुल गरे
acknowledged	स्वीकार गरे
conceded	स्वीकार गर्न बाध्य भए

Example:

Direct: He said, “I made a mistake.”

Indirect: He **admitted that** he had made a mistake.

10. Expressing Denial / अस्वीकार गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
denied	इन्कार/अस्वीकार गरे
rejected	अस्वीकार गरे
refuted	खण्डन गरे

disclaimed	दाबी अस्वीकार गरे
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Example:

Direct: She said, “I have not broken the window.”

Indirect: She **denied that** she had broken the window.

11. Expressing Regret / पछुतो व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
regretted	पछुतो गरिन्/गरे
expressed regret	पछुतो व्यक्त गरे
apologized	माफी मागे

Example:

Direct: He said, “I am sorry for my mistake.”

Indirect: He **expressed regret for** his mistake.

12. Expressing Happiness / खुशी व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
expressed happiness	खुशी व्यक्त गरे
rejoiced	हर्ष मनाए
celebrated	उत्सव मनाए
exclaimed with joy	खुशी हुँदै उद्गार गरे

Example:

Direct: She said, “I have passed the exam.”

Indirect: She **expressed happiness that** she had passed the exam.

13. Expressing Sadness / दुःख व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
expressed sadness	दुःख व्यक्त गरे

lamented	दुःख व्यक्त गरे/विलाप गरे
mourned	शोक मनाए
grieved	शोक गरे
exclaimed with sorrow	दुःखका साथ उद्गार गरे

14. Expressing Surprise / आश्चर्य व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
expressed surprise	आश्चर्य व्यक्त गरे
wondered	अचम्म माने/सोचे
exclaimed with surprise	आश्चर्यका साथ उद्गार गरे

Example:

Direct: He said, “What a beautiful place it is!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with surprise** **that** it was a very beautiful place.

15. Expressing Fear / डर व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
feared	डराए
expressed fear	डर व्यक्त गरे
was afraid	डराएका थिए
was frightened	भयभीत भए

Example:

Direct: He said, "I am afraid that I may fail."

Indirect: He **feared that** he might fail.

16. Expressing Hope / आशा व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
hoped	आशा गरे

wished	इच्छा/कामना गरे
looked forward to	उत्सुकतापूर्वक प्रतीक्षा गरे

Example:

Direct: She said, “I hope that I will succeed.”

Indirect: She **hoped that** she would succeed.

17. Expressing Doubt / शंका व्यक्त गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
doubted	शंका गरे
questioned	शंका/प्रश्न उठाए
wondered	सोच्यै शंका गरे

Example:

Direct: He said, “I doubt whether he will come.”

Indirect: He **doubted whether** he would come.

18. Making a Claim / दाबी गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
claimed	दाबी गरे
asserted	दृढतापूर्वक दाबी गरे
alleged	आरोप/दाबी गरे
maintained	आफ्नो दाबीमा अडिग रहे
contended	तर्कसहित दाबी गरे

Example:

Direct: He said, "I am the rightful owner."

Indirect: He **claimed** that he was the rightful owner.

19. Emphasizing / जोड दिँदा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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emphasized	जोड दिए
stressed	जोड दिए
highlighted	विशेष महत्त्व दिए
underlined	विशेष जोड दिए
pointed out	औल्याए

Example:

Direct: The teacher said, “Regular practice is important.”

Indirect: The teacher **emphasized that** regular practice was important.

20. Complaining / गुनासो गर्दा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
complained	गुनासो गरे
grumbled	गनगन गरे

protested	विरोध/आपत्ति जनाए
objected	आपत्ति जनाए

Example:

Direct: He said, “The room is too noisy.”

Indirect: He **complained that** the room was too noisy.

Important Structures

A. Most common structure

Subject + reporting verb + that + reported clause

He said, “I am busy.”

→ He **said that** he was busy.

B. With a person/object

Subject + reporting verb + object + that + clause

He said to me, “You are honest.”

→ He **told me that** I was honest.

C. Some reporting verbs take special prepositions

Verb	Structure
apologize	apologize for + V-ing/noun
complain	complain about + noun/V-ing
insist	insist on + V-ing/noun
object	object to + V-ing/noun
agree	agree with + person / agree to + noun
congratulate	congratulate someone on + noun/V-ing
accuse	accuse someone of + V-ing
admit	admit + V-ing/that-clause
deny	deny + V-ing/that-clause

★ Key Point

Do not select a reporting verb simply because the sentence is assertive. Select it according to the speaker's intended meaning. Reporting verb should convey the speaker's exact intention, not merely replace *said*.

For example:

- **He said that he was ill.** → simple statement
- **He informed me that he was ill.** → giving information
- **He admitted that he was ill.** → accepting a fact
- **He claimed that he was ill.** → making a claim
- **He complained that he was ill.** → expressing a complaint
- **He feared that he was ill.** → expressing fear
- **He believed that he was ill.** → expressing belief